Kiran Shah

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SUMMARY

Data Scientist focusing on Sports Analytics with professional MLS experience in player valuation and performance assessment. Excel at translating movement and event data into actionable insights for recruitment and performance.

EDUCATION

GEORGIA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY **Atlanta, GA**
Master of Science in Analytics *August 2024 – December 2025*
- Coursework: Regression, Bayesian Stats, Optimization, Machine Learning, Visualization ***GPA: 4.0/4.0***

UNIVERSITY OF FLORIDA **Gainesville, FL**
Bachelor of Science – Finance *August 2019 – May 2023*
- Magna Cum Laude and **top of class** ***GPA: 3.94/4.0***

SKILLS

Sports Analytics: player evaluation, event/possession valuation, spatial-temporal modeling, large-scale data processing
Tools and Libraries: Pandas, NumPy, PyMC, JMP Pro, scikit-learn, PyCaret, StatsbombPy, mplsoccer, nflreadpy, GCP
Languages: Python, R, SQL

EXPERIENCE

D.C. United (MLS) **Atlanta, GA**
Soccer Analytics Intern *May 2025 – January 2026*
- Developed a CatBoost player valuation model (R^2 = 0.91) using large-scale multi-source datasets (StatsBomb, Wyscout, web-scraped), producing interpretable insights to support roster decision-making
- Built metric stabilization and aging curves using mixed-effects modeling to separate true player skill from noise, improving the reliability of performance evaluation and transfer valuation

Merrill Lynch **Orlando, FL**
Financial Solutions Advisor *May 2022 – July 2024*
- Oversaw a $1.2 million portfolio of client assets and maintained a 100% client retention rate
- Delivered a diverse array of client-specific capital allocation strategies to approximately 25 clients each week

PROJECTS AND RESEARCH

Bayesian Framework for Quantifying Soccer Possession Value
Individual Research
- Developed Bayesian logistic regression model in PyMC to estimate possession-level goal probability from chains of discrete event data (~50,000 observations)
- Engineered spatiotemporal features to model how player actions influence possession-level outcomes
- Evaluated posterior robustness under semi-informative, uninformative, and strict priors using NUTS sampling

Olympic Performance Modeling and Interactive Dashboard
Project for United States Olympic and Paralympic Committee
- Implemented a two-stage mixed-effects model in Python to forecast long-track speed skating performance using historical race results while accounting for venue, age, and athlete-specific effects.
- Generated posterior simulations of race outcomes to estimate gold, silver, bronze, and overall medal probabilities with full uncertainty distributions for each athlete.
- Designed an interactive Tableau dashboard to communicate medal probabilities, expected finish ranks, and uncertainty intervals to coaches and high-performance staff.

AWARDS

Featured Merrill Advisor, North Florida Region | Cutler Finance Research Scholar | National Merit Scholar
Benacquisto Scholarship Recipient | Student Liaison to Academic Advisory Board, Georgia Tech MSA Program